

Module 04: Cognition — Brain Building

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Cognition** is Thinking.
2. Learn about **Memory** (Storing the past).
3. Know that your brain gets stronger when you use it!

Introduction: The Super Computer

Inside your head is a Super Computer made of meat. It is your Brain! It solves puzzles. It remembers names. It tells you stories. Just like muscles get big when you lift heavy things, your brain gets strong when you think hard thoughts.

Key Concepts

1. Memory (The Library)

Everything you learn goes into your Brain Library.

- **Short-Term:** "What did I just eat?" (Easy to find).
- **Long-Term:** "What is my Grandma's name?" (Deep in the stacks). Sleep helps the Librarians put the books away.

2. Focus (The Flashlight)

The world is noisy. To think, you have to shine your flashlight on ONE thing.

- If you look at the TV *and* the book, the flashlight is too dim.
- Focus means ignoring the noise.

3. Problem Solving (The Maze)

Life is full of puzzles.

- "How do I reach that cookie?"
- "How do I put these shoes on?" Your brain runs a simulation. "If I climb the chair -> I reach the cookie." "If I pull the laces -> The shoe stays on."

Activities

Activity 1: The Memory Tray

Put 5 items on a tray (Spoon, Toy, Key, Apple, Pen). Look at them for 1 minute. Cover the tray with a towel. How many can you remember? Take the towel off. Did you miss any? Your Brain Library is working!

Activity 2: The Block Puzzle

Build a bridge with blocks. Make it fall down. Ask: "Why did it fall?" (Gravity!). Build it again, but wider. Does it stand? You are debugging the world.

Summary

Your brain is the boss of your body. By practicing memory, focusing your attention, and solving problems, you are building a super-powered mind that can do anything.

References

- *The Most Magnificent Thing* by Ashley Spires
- *Your Fantastic Elastic Brain* by JoAnn Deak